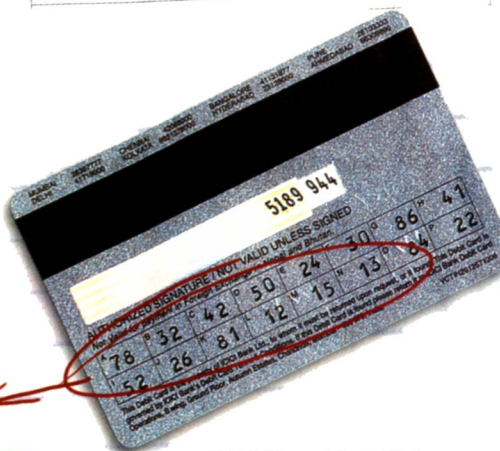


Trust Factor

Banks are coming out with smart innovations to make e-banking safer. Four instances

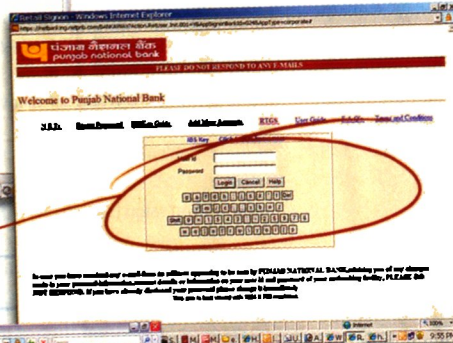
ICICI Bank's new grid-enabled debit card has an added security feature. Prior to online transactions, the computer will ask for any three grid numbers randomly.



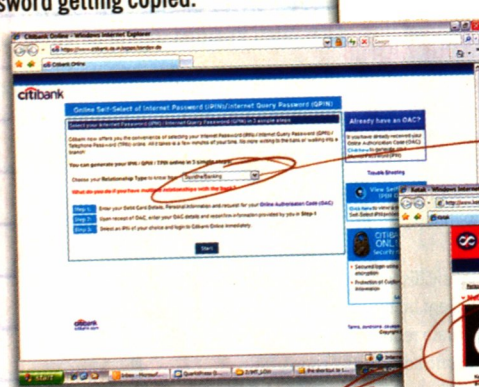
With HDFC Bank's NetSafe, a secure payment solution, you can now shop online through a virtual credit card that expires as soon as the transaction is done.



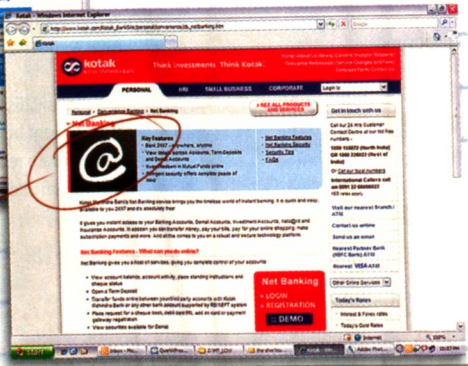
PNB's virtual keyboard prevents any possibility of your login and password getting copied.



CITIBANK's IPIN allows you to select your Internet password, instantly with a few clicks.



KOTAK MAHINDRA Bank has generated a virtual pre-set credit card that will let you e-shop within a 24-hour window.



entire m-banking service which includes query as well as m-commerce," says Jaydeep Gupta, regional head, shared distribution, Middle East, South Asia and Africa, Standard Chartered Bank. "The ratio of brick-and mortar banking to banking from home has changed from 80:20 to 20:80," he adds. Once m-banking catches on, the handset can replace debit and credit cards.

NOT JUST EASY BANKING, IT'S MORE BANKING

Branchless banking is much more than banking. As Vohra found out, it can pervade your entire financial portfolio. You bank much more than before, but with much less effort and cost. That's unsurprising. Banks are emerging as financial superstores offering everything from insurance to mutual funds. They are no longer mere wealth accumulators or custodians; they now help in wealth creation and wealth management.

THE GLITCHES IN E-BANKING

But before either banks or the customers aim higher, there are issues to be fixed. The most common fear is that of security. Most people avoid Net banking because they fear their account will be broken into by hackers. But banks are coming up with variety of innovations to beef up security at every stage of transaction, be it

Graphics by RAU

banking, phone banking is the most popular self-banking channel today. That may soon change, as mobile and Net banking converge on a complementary platform. Already, Net-enabled mobile phones are substituting the computer for a whole lot of services. In a country where mobile

phone usage is proliferating at a breakneck speed with over 185 million users, m-banking is the future. "Mobile banking has a huge potential as we see a convergence of Internet banking, tele-banking and merchant purchase all into m-banking. Our focus is now offering the

debit card or Punjab National Bank's (PNB) virtual keyboard that can be used to key in your login credential, thus defeating keyboard logging software, which may have been installed on the computer you are using (see box). Courtesy all these measures, Irfan Khan, a Mumbai-based retired